AskDocPH: Platform Architecture & Product Specification

AskDocPH is a specialized Philippine social media platform designed to bridge the gap between mental health support and professional medical guidance. By integrating an AI Help Desk with a verified community of licensed professionals, the platform provides a safe environment for Filipinos to share sentiments, seek counseling, and access mental health resources.

1. User Roles & Registration Workflows

The platform supports three distinct user roles, each with specific onboarding requirements and permissions.

1. Capability Matrix (Can vs. Can't)

This matrix defines what features a user can access based on their current status.

Status	Social Feed / Feed Posting	Support Group (Create)	Messenger (Peer-to-Peer)	AI Companion Chat	Apply to Medical Panel	Handle Help Requests
Guest	👁 View Only	❌	❌	❌	✅	❌
User (`none`)	✅	❌	✅	✅	❌ (Blocked)	❌
User (`applying`)	✅	❌	✅	✅	✅	❌
User (`pending`)	✅	❌	✅	✅	🔄 (Waiting)	❌
User (`rejected`)	✅	❌	✅	✅	✅ (Re-apply)	❌
Doctor (`approved`)	✅	✅	✅	✅	❌ (Verified)	✅

NOTE
Pending Users are severely restricted to prevent system abuse while under review. They are redirected to a "Pending" splash screen. **Rejected Users** regain social capabilities but must "Petition to Re-apply" to restart the application process.

→ Regular User Role

Designed for individuals seeking support or community engagement.

- **Registration Data:** First Name, Middle Name, Last Name, Gender, Birthday, Username, Email Address, and Password.
- **Capabilities:** Create posts, join groups, access resources, follow users, and use the AI Crisis Support.

→ Healthcare Professional (Doctor) Role

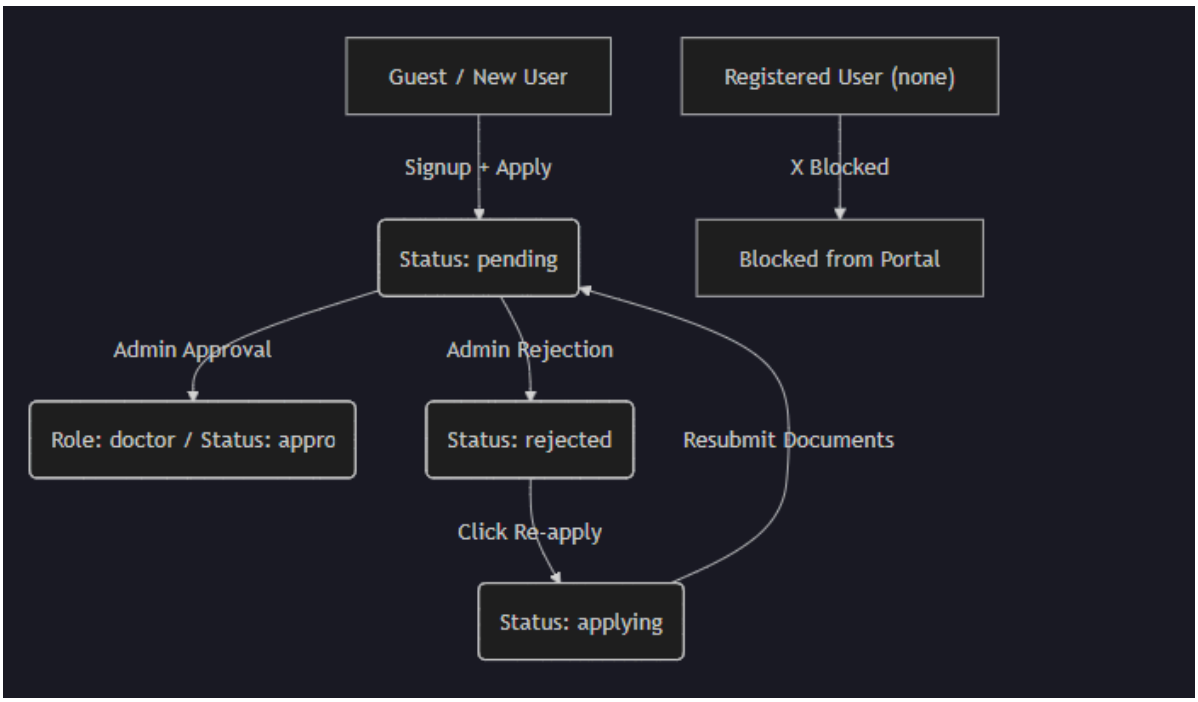
A verified role for licensed practitioners (MDs, RNs, Psychologists).

- **Registration Data:**
  - **Personal Information:** Full Name, Gender, Birthday.
  - **Credentials:** Unique Username and Professional Email.

    - **Professional Information:** Selection of Professional Titles (e.g., Psychologist, Mental Health Therapist).
    - **Verification Documents:** Licensed ID, Resume/Portfolio (Optional), and Certificates (Optional).
    - **Liveliness Video:** A short video recording to prevent fraudulent applications.
    - **Biometric Verification:** A live Face ID check matching the submitted ID. Raw images are not stored; only a secure verification hash and timestamp are retained.
- **Capabilities:** Create/Manage groups, author professional articles (Resources), set "Online" status, and provide professional advocacy.

The Doctor Application Lifecycle

How a user transitions into a verified medical professional.



Flow Breakdown:

1. Initial Submission: New users submit credentials during registration. Their doctor_status is set to pending.
2. Access Restriction: While pending, if the user tries to access the application form again, they are redirected to a "Waiting" screen. They are not blocked from the social feed or messenger.
3. Admin Review: Administrator reviews the application on the admin/applications/show portal.
4. Approval: User is upgraded to doctor role and approved status. They gain access to the Doctor Portal.
5. Rejection: User status becomes rejected. They regain access to the "Apply" section but must click "Re-apply" to clear the old application data.
6. The Re-application Bridge: Clicking "Re-apply" sets the status to applying. This is a temporary state that allows the user to see the submission form again and submit fresh documents.

→ Administrative Role

The governing body of the platform.

- **Capabilities:** Review and approve/decline doctor applications, manage the list of professional titles, post daily affirmation quotes, and communicate through internal admin-to-admin chat.

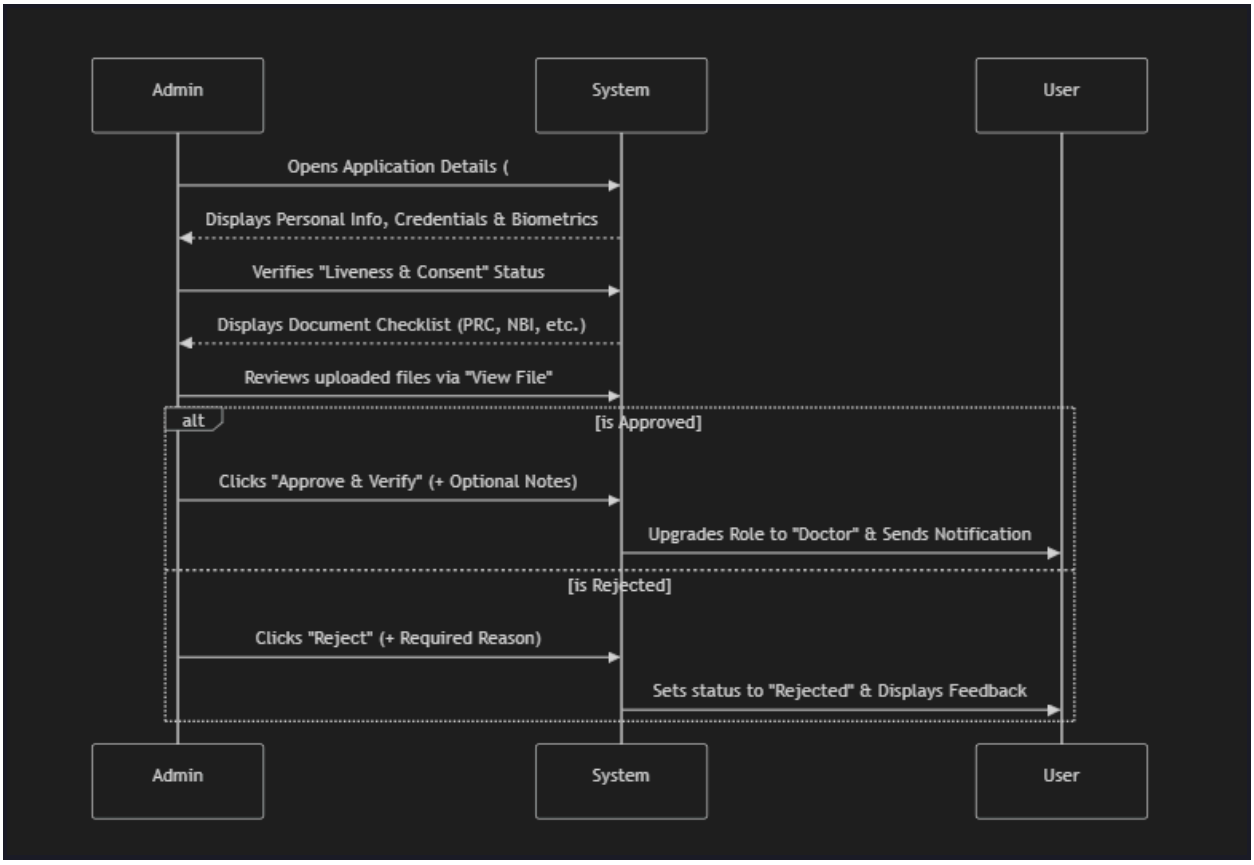
Review Guidelines:

1. **Biometric Integrity:** Administrators must confirm the "Liveness Verified" status to ensure the applicant is a natural person rather than a digital reproduction or automated bot.

2. **Credential Verification:** Every mandatory document, including the PRC License and Government ID, must be individually inspected for validity, authenticity, and expiration dates.
3. **Feedback Mechanism:** In the event of a rejection, completing the **admin_notes** field is required. This information is shared with the user to facilitate an informed re-application process.

Administrator Review Workflow

When an administrator reviews a pending application, they follow this exact verification process:



Discovery & Automation Rules:

1. **The 15-Minute Rule:** Only doctors who have been active within the last 15 minutes and are approved will appear in the AI's recommendation list.
2. **Crisis Protocol:** If the AI detects keywords like "suicide" or "harm," it skips doctor matching and immediately displays emergency hotlines for the Philippines (NCMH 1553).
3. **Automated Greeting:** Upon acceptance, the system automatically sends a message from the doctor: "Hello! I have accepted your request... How can I help you today?" This ensures the patient is engaged immediately.
4. **Instant Redirection:** The patient does not need to refresh. The AI modal polls the server every 5 seconds and will automatically trigger the Messenger UI once the doctor hits "Accept."

Platform Core Features

Feature	Description	Access Level
Global Feed	A space to share sentiments and stories. Interacted with via likes/comments.	All Users
AI Crisis Support	A listening-focused AI that analyzes emotions. It cannot diagnose; it suggests approved doctors for professional help.	All Users

Feature	Description	Access Level
Community Groups	Forums for specific mental health topics and advocacy.	Created by Doctors
Resource Library	Educational articles and mental health tools.	Authored by Doctors
Direct Messaging	Private communication channel for peer support or professional inquiry.	All Users & Doctors

The Admin panel is the central hub for maintaining platform integrity:

1. **Doctor Onboarding:** Admins review the Liveliness Video and ID hash. They have the power to approve or decline applications.
2. **Affirmation Engine:** Admins curate and schedule daily affirmation quotes that appear on the user feed to promote positive mental well-being.
3. **Title Management:** Admins define which professional titles are available for new applicants to ensure only recognized medical designations are used.
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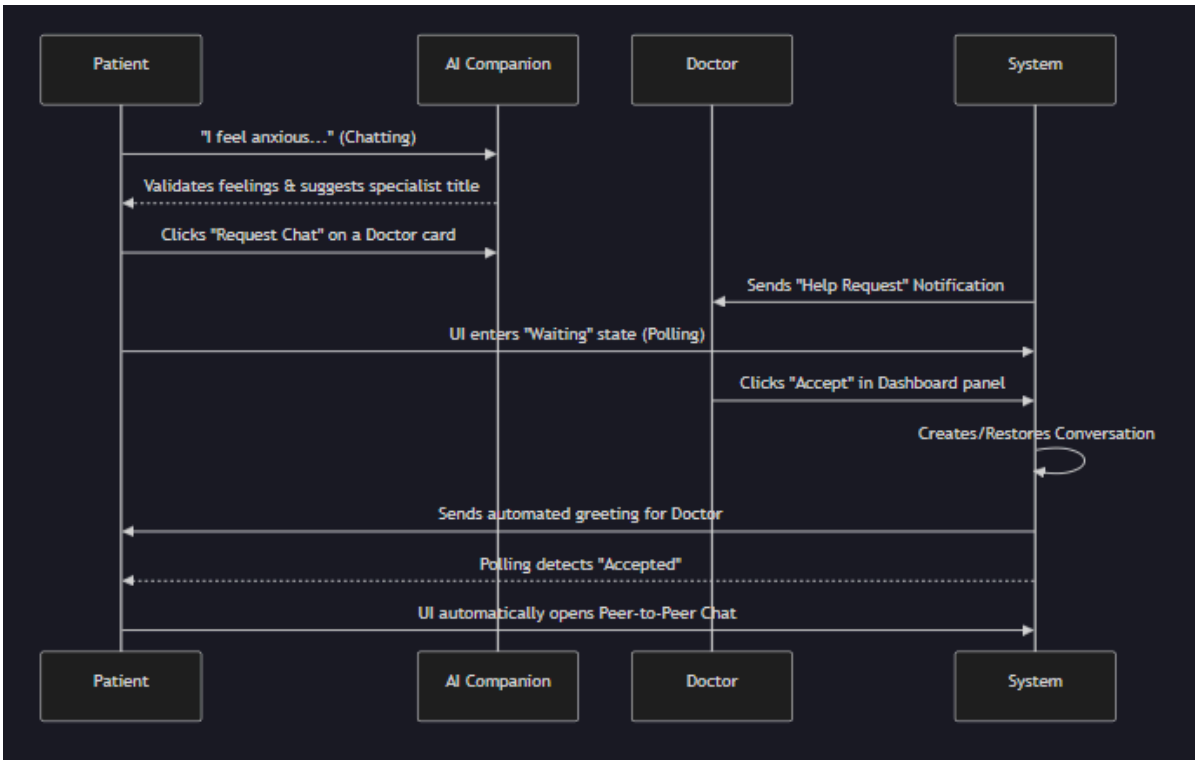
2. The AI Help Desk & Crisis Support

The AI Help Desk serves as the first point of contact for users in distress.

- **Emotional Analysis:** The AI is programmed to listen and analyze the user's emotional state through natural language processing.
- **Safety Guardrails:** It is explicitly restricted from making medical diagnoses.
- **Professional Referral:** If the AI detects a need for clinical intervention, it provides a curated list of "Approved Doctors" who are currently online and available for professional help.

Consultation & Help Flow

How an approved doctor interacts with patients seeking help.



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3. User Experience: "My Profile"

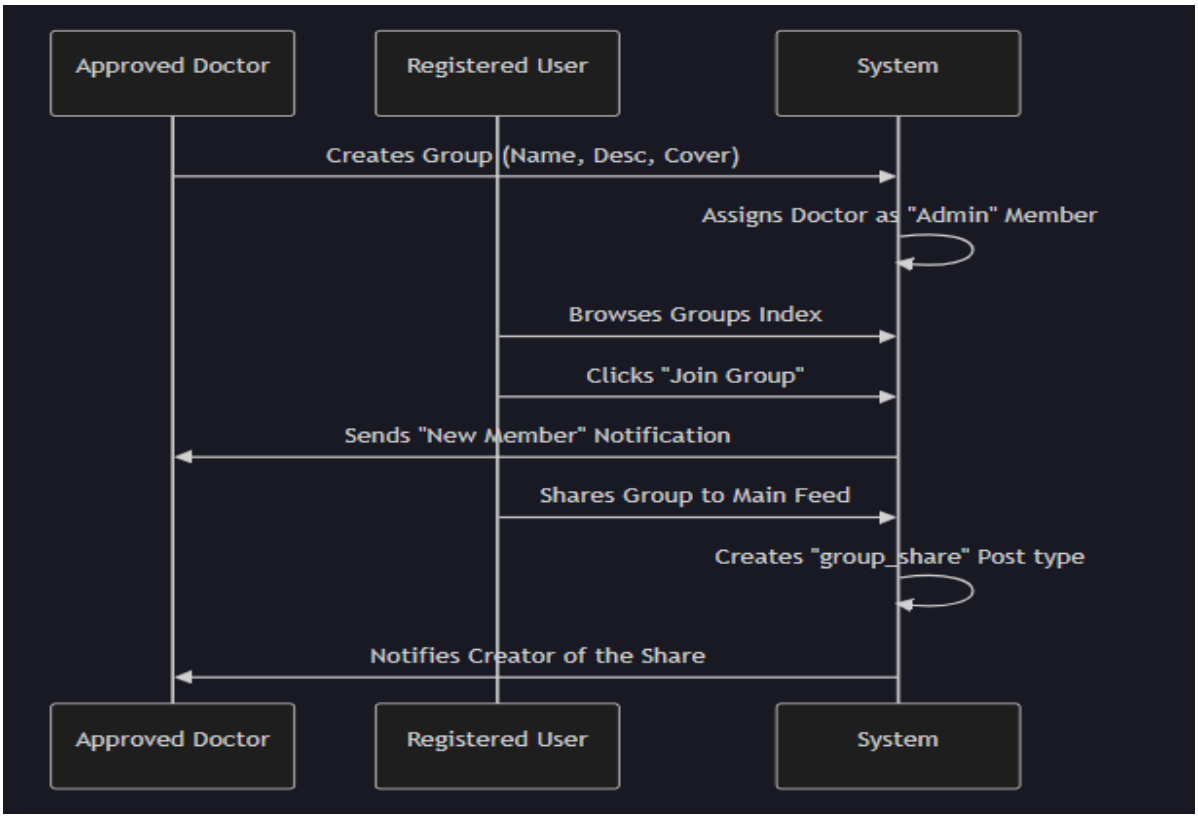
The Profile page serves as a personal dashboard for managing the user's journey on AskDocPH.

- **Engagement Metrics:** Displays counts for posts created, groups joined, and resources followed.
- **Group & Resource View:** A dedicated view to manage and navigate through joined communities and saved educational content.
- **The Network:** A specialized tab to view "Following" and "Followers" lists to maintain community connections.
- **Saved Posts:** A private repository for posts the user has flagged for future reference.
- **Professional Application Tracking:** For those who have initiated a doctor application, a dedicated "Application" button appears to track the status (Pending, Approved, or Declined). If declined, doctors can re-apply based on Admin feedback provided in this section.

4. User Experience: “Support Group”

The "Support Group" feature in AskDocPH addresses the critical need for safe, specialized communities where individuals can engage in peer support and advocacy. Recognizing that many users prefer anonymous or digital-first consultations due to stigma or cost, these groups provide a curated environment for sharing lived experiences while maintaining professional oversight. By fostering these digital micro-communities, the platform effectively reduces geographical and social barriers to mental health support in the Philippines.

How specialized communities are created and managed by medical professionals.

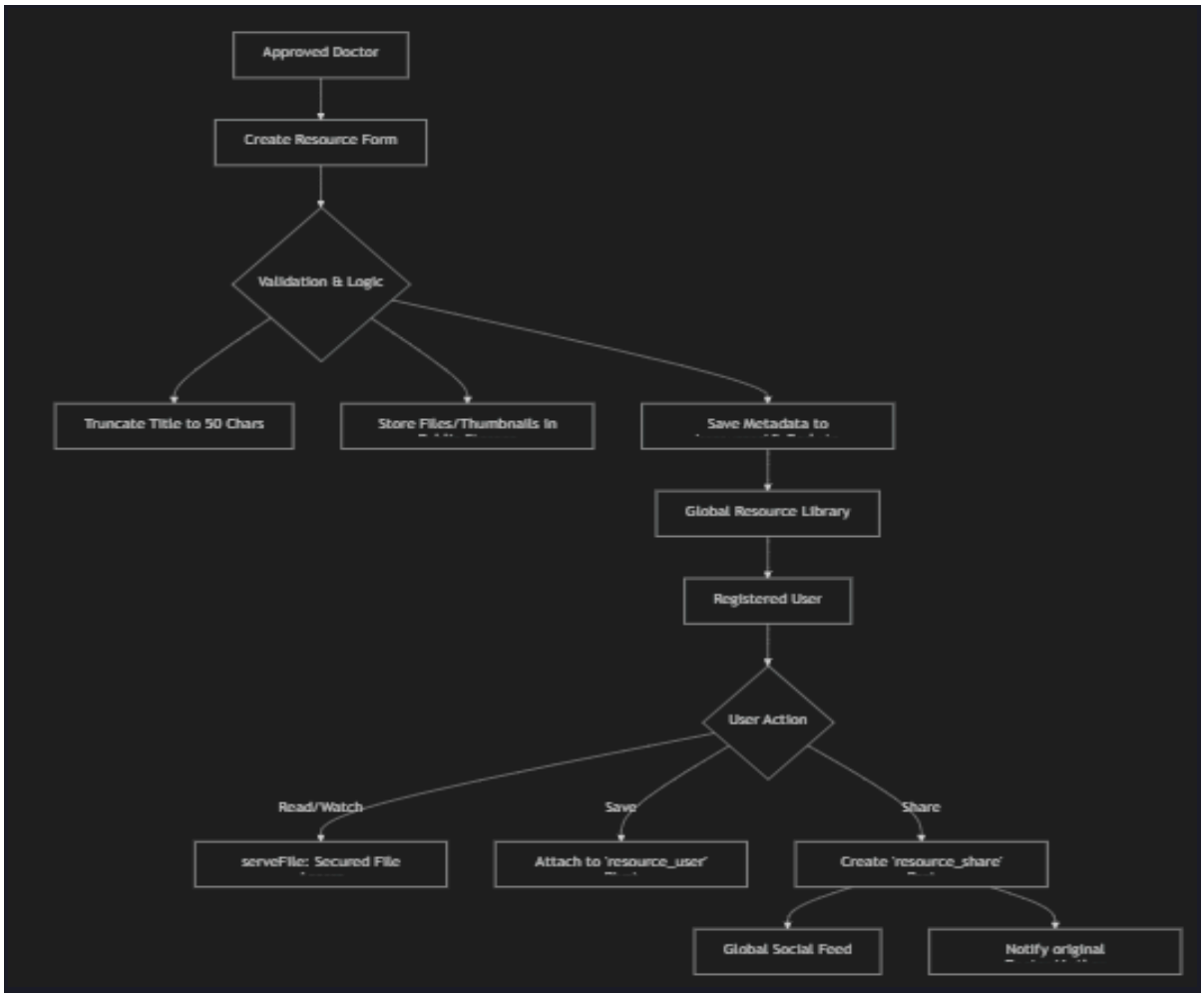


Management & Interaction Rules:

1. **Creation Rights:** Only users with **doctor_status = approved** can create groups. Regular users or pending applicants are restricted from the creation portal.
2. **Membership:** Any authenticated user can join an unlimited number of groups.
3. **Admin Controls:** The original creator has exclusive rights to:
    - Edit Group Name and Description.
    - Update or Delete the Group Cover Photo.
    - Delete the Group entirely.
4. **Social Sharing:** Members can "Share" a group to the platform's global feed. This creates a specialized post that links back to the group, helping doctors grow their support communities.

5. User Experience: “Resources”

The “Resources” section is designed to be a definitive, professionally-curated educational library for users. By providing a repository of articles and mental health tools exclusively authored by verified Healthcare Professionals, the platform ensures that users have access to reliable, high-quality, and contextually relevant information. This feature serves as a key pillar in the platform's mission to offer authoritative guidance alongside community support.

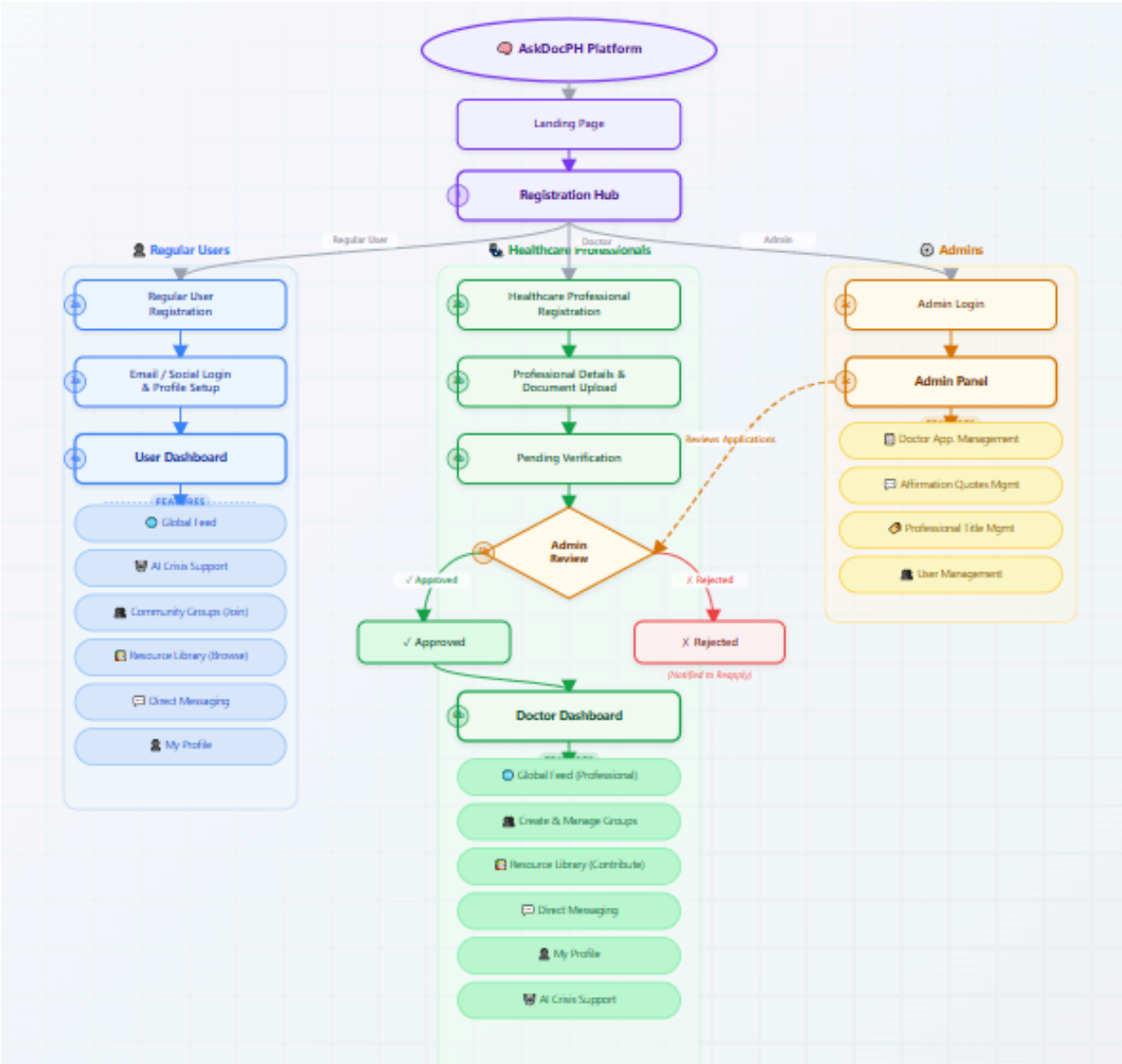


Management & Interaction Rules:

1. **Doctor-Led Content:** Only users with **doctor_status = approved** are authorized to create or update resource materials.
2. **Title Optimization:** To maintain a clean UI display, resource titles are automatically constrained to 50 characters via the **limitGraphemes()** function.
3. **Multi-Media Support:** The platform facilitates specialized file management for educational enrichment, including PDF workbooks, MP3 audio therapy, and MP4 videos.
4. **Sharing Loop:** Sharing a resource triggers a **resource_share** post and notifies the professional author, fostering a collaborative feedback environment.

User Interaction:

- **Save for Later:** Authenticated users may "Save" resources to a private repository, with data managed through the **resource_user** pivot table.
- **Social Amplification:** Members can cross-post resources to the global feed with personalized commentary to increase community reach.



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